

 Kelly Todhunter

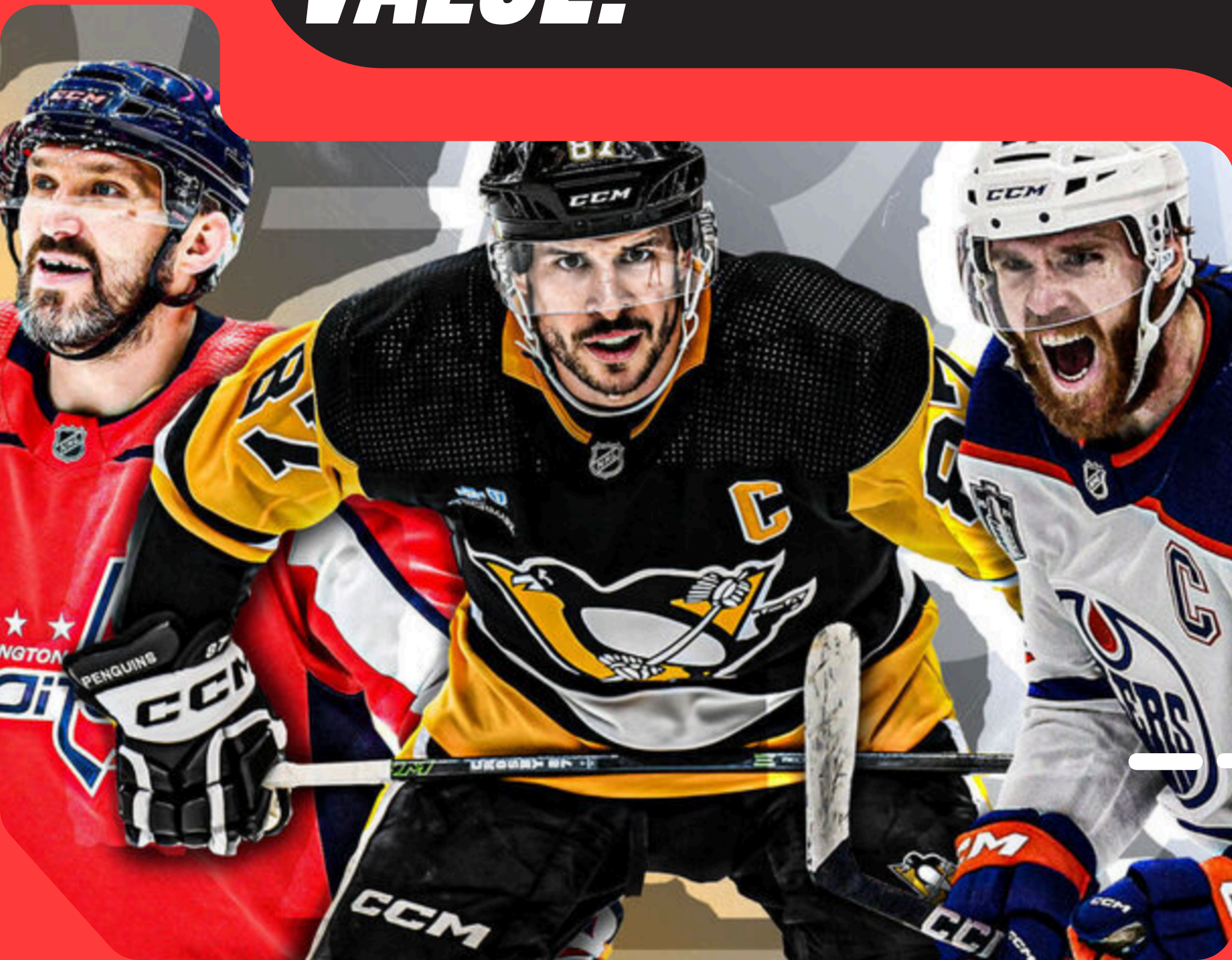
What Players Perform Best
Based on their Salary?

NHL PLAYER * VALUE DASHBOARD





WHY PLAYER VALUE?



Teams are always trying to manage their salary cap, and with tighter enforcement of playoff rosters and rising limits, it's important to find good players who perform well with regard to their salary. Are there forwards that outperform their salary? Are there defensemen who block the most shots per \$1M? Are there goalies that outperform expected goals against? Are there players who are actually underrated based on traditional statistics? Looking at player value, we can answer all of these questions and more to help inform teams which players will help their team win at better prices.

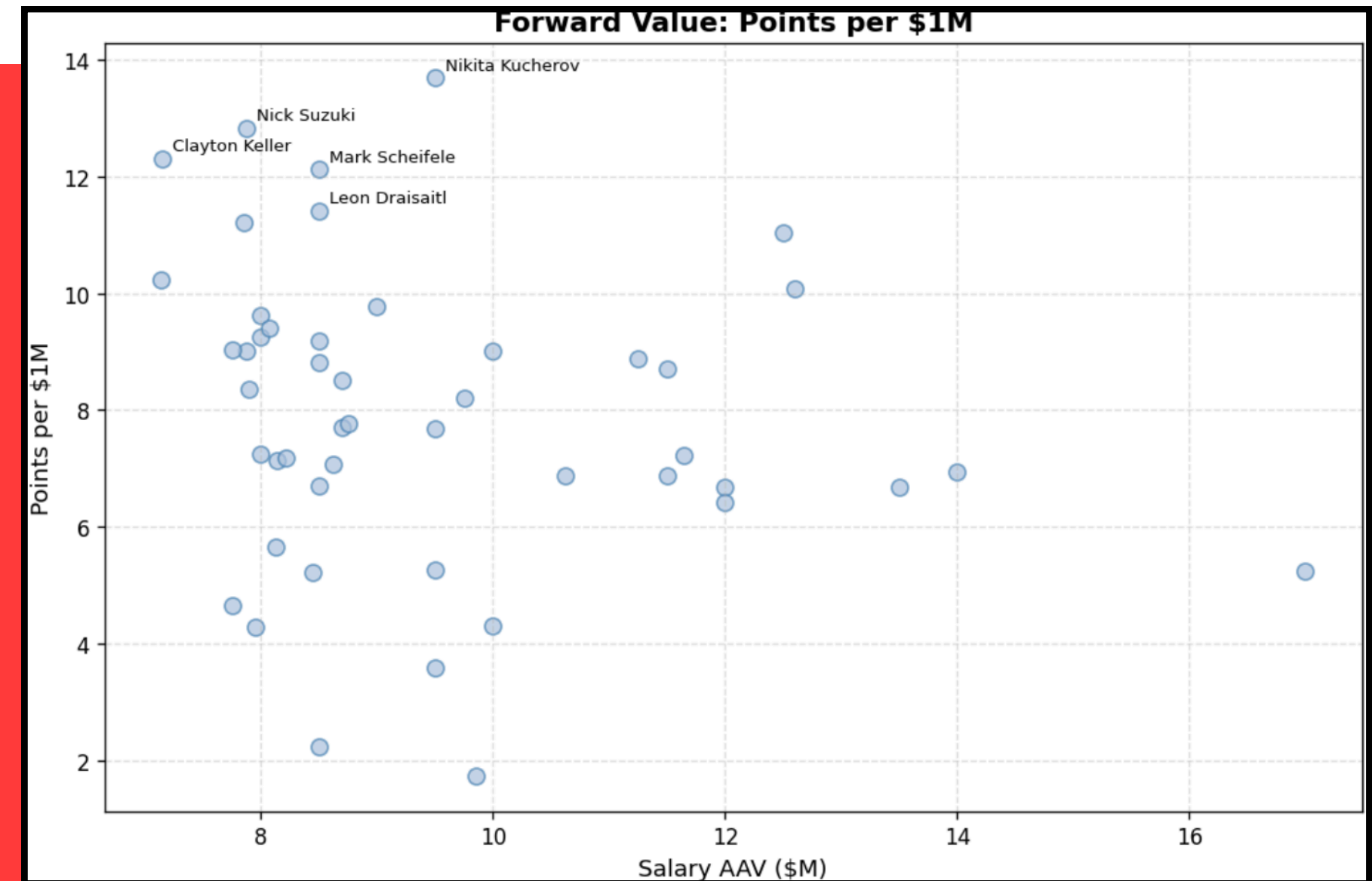
* *FORWARD VALUE PER \$1 IN THEIR SALARY*

name	I_F_points	AAV	points_per_million
Nikita Kucherov	130.0	9500000	13.684211
Nick Suzuki	101.0	7875000	12.825397
Clayton Keller	88.0	7150000	12.307692
Mark Scheifele	103.0	8500000	12.117647
Leon Draisaitl	97.0	8500000	11.411765
Cole Caufield	88.0	7850000	11.210191
Connor McDavid	138.0	12500000	11.040000
Dylan Guenther	73.0	7142857	10.220000
Nathan MacKinnon	127.0	12600000	10.079365
Jake Guentzel	88.0	9000000	9.777778

Top 10 Most Underrated Players of the 2025–2026 Season

These players had the highest points per \$1 million in salary, based on their AAV (Average Annual Value).

These players were able to produce the most on the ice per \$1 million in their contract



Graph based on Over 100 Players of data in the 25–26 Season

The players concentrated in the top left, having a low Average Annual Value but a high production of points

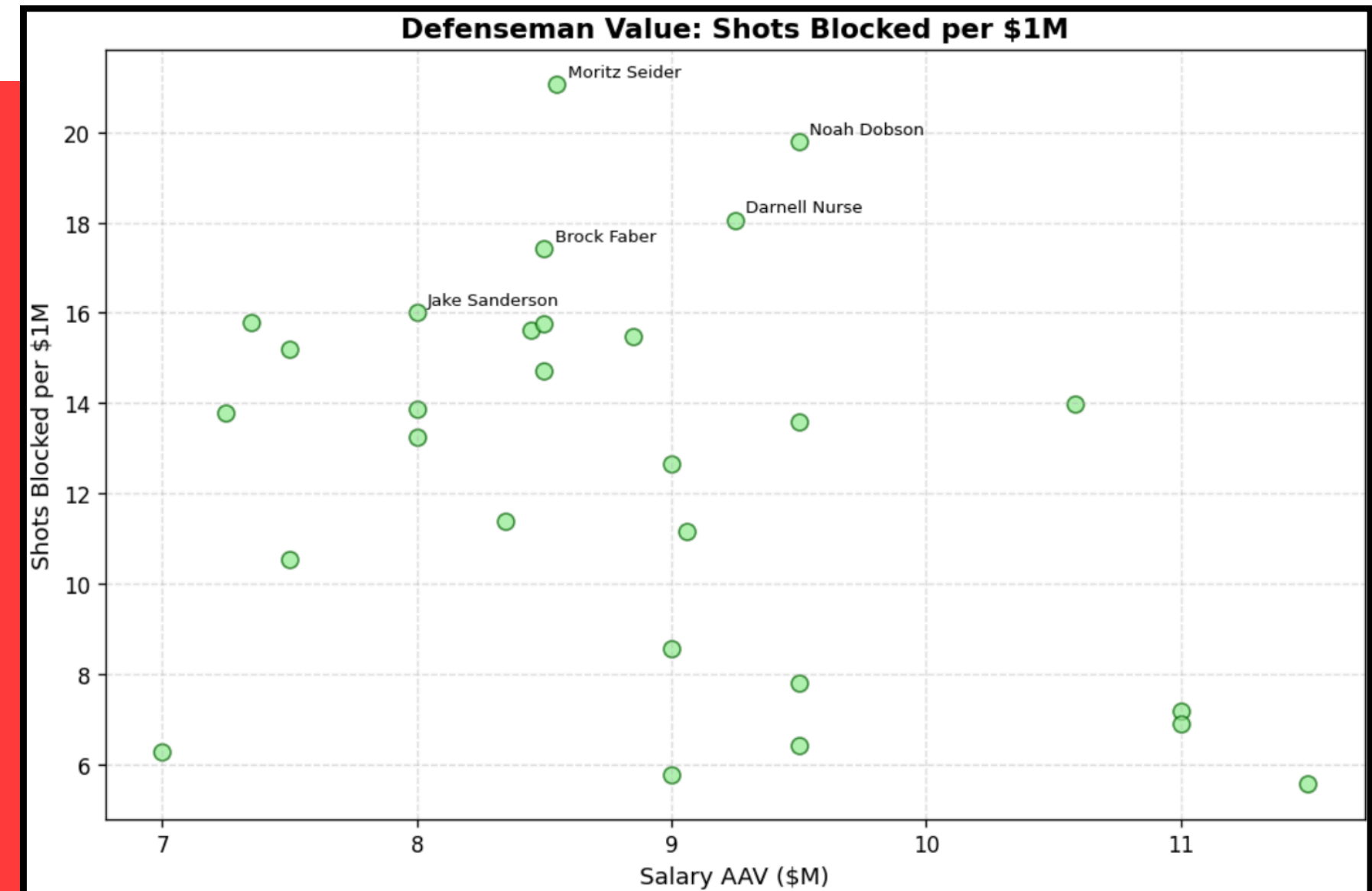
* *DEFENSE SHOTS BLOCKED PER \$1 IN THEIR SALARY*

Top 10 Defensemen by Shots Blocked per \$1M:

name	shotsBlockedByPlayer	AAV	shots_blocked_per_million
Moritz Seider	180.0	8550000	21.052632
Noah Dobson	188.0	9500000	19.789474
Darnell Nurse	167.0	9250000	18.054054
Brock Faber	148.0	8500000	17.411765
Jake Sanderson	128.0	8000000	16.000000
Noah Hanifin	116.0	7350000	15.782313
Ivan Provorov	134.0	8500000	15.764706
Miro Heiskanen	132.0	8450000	15.621302
Lane Hutson	137.0	8850000	15.480226
Morgan Rielly	114.0	7500000	15.200000

Top 10 Most Underrated Defensemen of the 2025–2026 Season

These players had the highest shots blocked per \$1 million in salary, based on their AAV (Average Annual Value). These players were able to suppress the most shots produced by the opposing team, giving their team a better chance of winner per \$1 million in their contract



Graph based on Over 100 Players of data in the 25–26 Season

The players concentrated in the top left, have a low Average Annual Value but a high amount of blocked shots

* *GOALS SAVED PER \$1 IN THEIR SALARY*

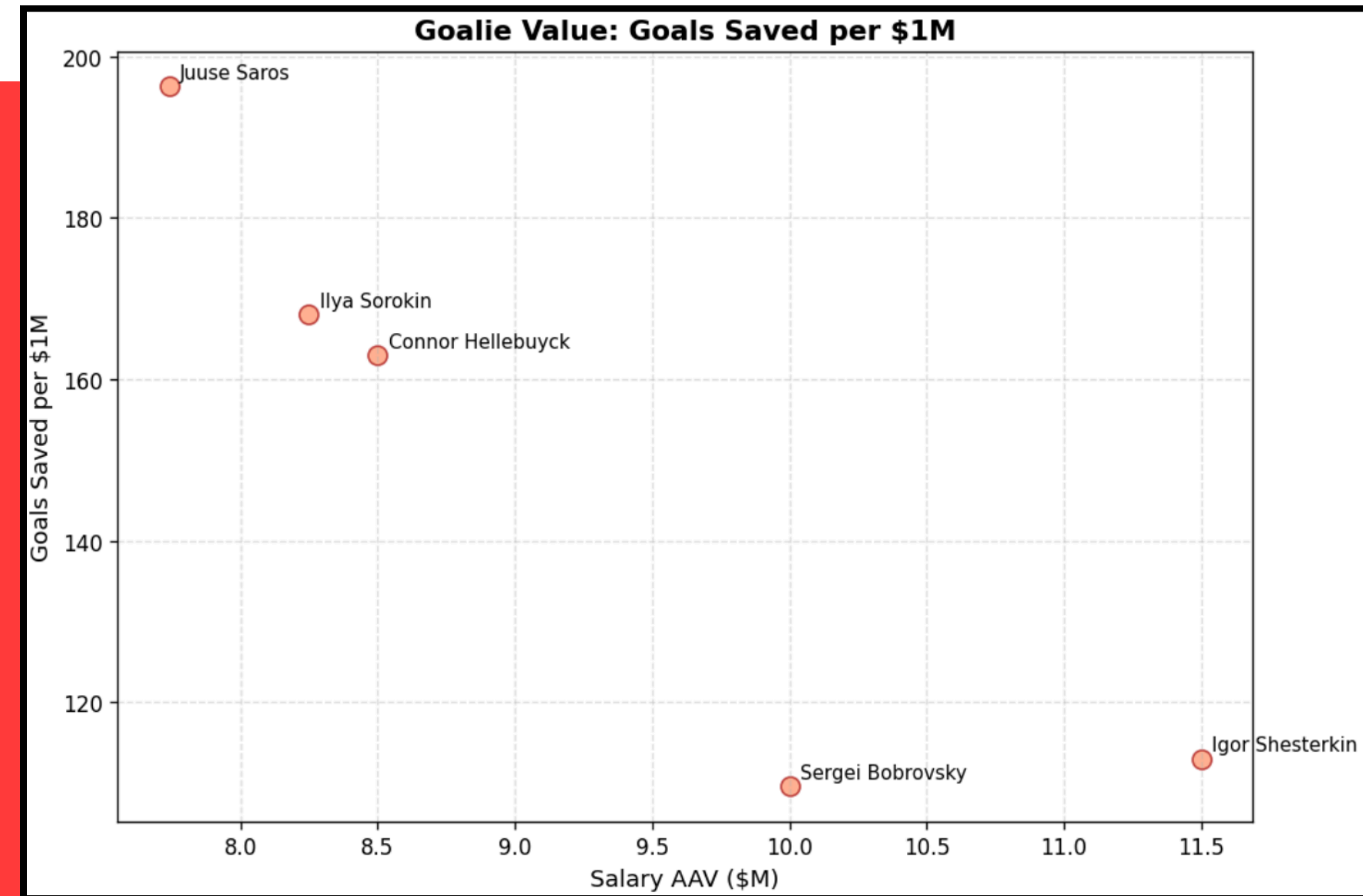
Goalies by Goals Saved per \$1M:

	name	ongoal	goals	goals_saved	AAV	goals_saved_per_million
	Juuse Saros	1700.0	181.0	1519.0	7740000	196.253230
	Ilya Sorokin	1530.0	144.0	1386.0	8250000	168.000000
	Connor Hellebuyck	1547.0	162.0	1385.0	8500000	162.941176
	Igor Shesterkin	1425.0	126.0	1299.0	11500000	112.956522
	Sergei Bobrovsky	1250.0	154.0	1096.0	10000000	109.600000

Top 5 Most Underrated Gaolies of the 2025–2026

Season

These players had the highest shots on goal per \$1 million in salary, based on their AAV (Average Annual Value). These goalies faced the most shots on goal and letting in the least amount of goals per \$1 Million in their contract. Given only 5 Goalies had high enough contracts to qualify in this data set



Graph based on Goalie data in the 25–26 Season

The players concentrated in the top left, have a high amount of saved goals in terms of \$1 Million per year in their contract.